

James M. Topmiller

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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Full-stack software developer with an engineering background and 9+ years of analytical problem-solving experience. Built and deployed multiple web applications using React, Node.js, Express, Python, Flask, PostgreSQL, and SQLite. Experienced building REST APIs, integrating Stripe payments, implementing JWT authentication, automating email workflows with Resend, and deploying applications on Vercel and Render. Passionate about building responsive, user-focused web applications.

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Languages: JavaScript, Python, SQL, HTML5, CSS3

Frontend: React, React Router, Context API, Redux

Backend: Node.js, Express, Flask, REST APIs

Databases: PostgreSQL, SQLite, SQLite

Cloud & Tools: Git, GitHub, Vercel, Render, Stripe, Cloudinary, Resend, Docker

Other: JWT Authentication, API Integration, Responsive Web Design, Web Scraping, Payment Processing

PROJECTS

JT's Vinyl Store (Full-Stack E-Commerce App)

<https://jtvinylstore.vercel.app>

React, Node.js, Express, SQLite, Stripe, JWT, Resend

- Built full-stack e-commerce platform with authentication, cart functionality, and checkout flow
- Integrated Stripe Checkout with webhook-based payment processing, persistent order storage, and automated order confirmation emails using Resend.
- Designed RESTful backend for managing users, products, and orders
- Managed global state (cart + auth) using React Context API

- Deployed frontend (Vercel) and backend (Render), accounting for cold-start performance

Kings Island Coasters

<https://kingsislandcoasters.vercel.app>

React, React Router, JSON, Responsive Design

- Built an interactive historical web application documenting Kings Island's roller coaster collection
- Designed reusable React components and dynamic routing
- Structured and maintained large JSON datasets for coasters, manufacturers, timelines, and park history
- Developed timeline and detail views for historical exploration
- Deployed frontend (Vercel)

Which Beatle Said It (Full-Stack Trivia App)

<https://which-beatle-said-it.vercel.app>

React, Node.js, Express, SQLite, JWT, bcrypt

- Developed full-stack trivia game with user authentication and persistent high scores
- Implemented JWT-based authentication and secure password hashing (bcrypt)
- Built REST API for game logic, user management, and score tracking
- Designed randomized quiz engine and guest play mode
- Deployed frontend (Vercel) and backend (Render), accounting for cold-start performance

Cheap Machines Website (Band Website)

<https://cheapmachines-music.vercel.app>

React, React Router, Responsive Design, Resend

- Designed and deployed (Vercel) a responsive React website for an independent band
- Created pages for music, shows, media, and contact information
- Built reusable components for future content updates
- Implemented a serverless contact form with Resend email delivery.

Zen Zinnati Music App (Music Streaming Platform & Merchandise Store)

<https://zenzinnatimusic.vercel.app>

React, React Router, Cloudinary, Stripe, Resend

- Developed a responsive music portfolio and streaming platform for an independent artist
 - Built a merchandise store with Stripe-powered checkout and Resend-powered contact form notifications.
 - Implemented persistent audio playback across routes using React
 - Integrated Cloudinary for media hosting and delivery
 - Designed dynamic album, track, and merchandise pages from structured data
 - Deployed frontend (Vercel) and backend (Render), accounting for cold-start performance
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TECHNICAL TRAINING

- Modern React with Redux (Udemy)

- REST API Development with Python & Flask (Udemy)

- freeCodeCamp Full Stack Curriculum:

- **HTML & CSS | JavaScript | React | Python | Relational Databases**
- **APIs & Microservices**

- Web Scraping for Beginners – API Data Extraction (freeCodeCamp)

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Land Surveying Technician / Drafter

Surveying and Drafting Services, Inc. — Remote/Hollywood, CA

(February 2016 – April 2025)

- Performed precision-based geometric computations and spatial data analysis
- Translated field data into structured digital models
- Interpreted technical documentation and regulatory requirements

- Collaborated cross-functionally to deliver accurate technical outputs

Architectural Drafter / Manager

N.E. Designs Inc. — Sherman Oaks, CA

(November 2014 – November 2015)

- Created detailed technical plans and documentation
- Applied regulatory requirements to design specifications
- Managed revisions based on compliance feedback

Engineering Intern / Co-op

City of Cincinnati — Cincinnati, OH

(June 2011 – September 2012)

- Assisted in infrastructure drafting and GIS-based mapping
- Performed quantity calculations and cost estimations
- Collaborated across engineering and planning teams

EDUCATION

University of Cincinnati — Bachelor's Degree

Civil / Environmental Engineering (June 2012)